MAIN IDEA AND DETAILS

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the paragraph. The main idea is what the whole paragraph is about, in one sentence. The details are facts that support it. Fill in the boxes.

Elephants

87 words

Elephants are the largest animals that live on land. An adult elephant can weigh as much as four cars. Its trunk is a nose and an upper lip joined together, and it has more than 40,000 muscles. Elephants use their trunks to drink, to pick up food and to spray water over their backs on hot days. Their big ears help them keep cool, too, by letting heat escape. Elephants live in family groups led by the oldest female. They can live for 60 years or more.

Main idea

↓ ↓ ↓

Detail 1

Detail 2

Detail 3

MAIN IDEA AND DETAILS ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the paragraph. The main idea is what the whole paragraph is about, in one sentence. The details are facts that support it. Fill in the boxes.

Elephants

87 words

Elephants are the largest animals that live on land. An adult elephant can weigh as much as four cars. Its trunk is a nose and an upper lip joined together, and it has more than 40,000 muscles. Elephants use their trunks to drink, to pick up food and to spray water over their backs on hot days. Their big ears help them keep cool, too, by letting heat escape. Elephants live in family groups led by the oldest female. They can live for 60 years or more.

Main idea

Elephants are huge land animals with special body parts and family groups that help them live.

↓ ↓ ↓

Detail 1

The trunk (a nose and lip with 40,000 muscles) is used to drink, pick up food and spray water.

Detail 2

Big ears let heat escape and keep the elephant cool.

Detail 3

Elephants live in family groups led by the oldest female and can live 60 years or more.